



Figure 1: Error with Notepad for a file size greater than 1GB
(Image source: www.google.com)

common applications that generate a large amount of data could be more than 1GB in size and we may need to read them. As the file size increases, handling them becomes a tedious task. Generally, we come across the following issues while attempting to handle large files:

- The system may hang while attempting to open large (GB) log files.
- The system will slow down due to full RAM usage by the opened large text file while the editor is in use.
- While attempting to open some 1GB sized text files, the built-in text editor of the Windows application, Notepad, can show some serious error messages like *The file is too large for Notepad*. In such cases, we need to use another editor to edit the file.

To interpret the information of these files carefully without facing such issues, we need some good editors that allow us to open, read and edit the files. So let's discuss some basic editor tools, which could be handy for these tasks.

Open source tools to handle large files

Notepad++

Notepad++ is an advanced and feature-rich sibling of the Notepad text editor that you find in the Windows OS. It is for those who want a very simple and easy UI with a great feature set, as it is clean, very fast and an excellent way to get work done. It is a lightweight replacement for Notepad, and is better than Microsoft Notepad in every possible way. It supports multiple tabs to open different files in a single window. It also supports multiple programming languages. Some of the languages supported by Notepad++ are C, C++, Java, C#, XML, HTML, PHP, JavaScript, VB/VBS, SQL, Perl, Python, UNIX shell script, etc.

Notepad++ is commonly known as the best HTML editor. It supports coloured lines and reports code error at the same instant. Besides, its functionality can be extended by using the hundreds of available plugins.

Key features

- WYSIWYG (What You See Is What You Get).
- User defined syntax highlighting and auto-completion.



Figure 2: Notepad++ text editor logo (Image source: www.google.com)

- Has the multi-document and multi-view feature.
- Regular expression and the 'multiple file search, mark and replace' feature is supported.
- Full drag-and-drop support.
- Support for a multi-language environment support.
- Being built for the Windows platform, it can also run on Linux, UNIX and Mac OS X (using Wine).
- Macro recording and playback.
- Zooming for those afflicted with sore eyes from staring at computer screens.
- Comes in both 'installer' and 'zipped' versions for people who don't have admin rights on their work computers.

Disadvantages

- Third party program (Wine) needed to run the application on Mac OS X.
- Remote file editing does not support HTTP, SSH or WebDAV.

Glogg

Glogg is a multi-platform, open source GUI application tool for viewing and searching large, complex log and data files. It is a very quick tool as it reads data directly from disk and does not load it entirely into memory, which

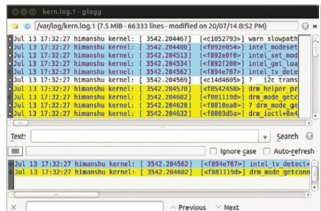


Figure 3: Log file opened with Glogg (Image source: www.google.com)